

KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558-69

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Name: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558			
L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559			
L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement			
L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the rigid structure of Elizabethan society, the concept of the Great Chain of Being, and the mechanics of Tudor government, including the roles of the Court, Privy Council, and Parliament.
- ☐ Analyse the intense challenges Elizabeth faced regarding her legitimacy, sixteenth-century gender prejudices against a 'Queen Regnant', and the political dilemma of marriage.
- ☐ Evaluate the interconnected domestic and foreign threats facing England in 1558, specifically severe financial weaknesses, the loss of Calais, and the dangerous 'Auld Alliance' between France and Scotland.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What vital English territory was lost to France in 1559 under the Treaty of Cateau-Cambr sis?

2. Define: Queen Regnant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Auld Alliance' viewed as a direct geographical threat to Elizabethan England?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about why Catholics viewed Elizabeth as an illegitimate monarch.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Great Chain of Being | Patronage | Privy Council | Queen Regnant | Legitimacy | Debasement | Auld Alliance

When Elizabeth ascended the throne in 1558, Tudor society was strictly organized according to the _____, a hierarchical structure where everyone had a fixed place. To maintain control and reward loyalty, the Queen relied heavily on the system of _____, distributing land and titles to powerful nobles. She was advised by a small, elite group of trusted ministers called the _____. However, as an unmarried _____, she faced immense challenges, including Catholic doubts about her _____, economic ruin caused by the _____ of the coinage, and the constant foreign threat of the _____ between France and Scotland.

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. Describe one feature of Elizabethan society in 1558.

Exam Q2. Describe one feature of Elizabethan government in 1558.

Exam Q3. Describe one feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558.

Exam Q4. Describe one feature of the French threat to England in 1558.

Exam Q5. Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558. Stimulus: Her parents' marriage / Mary, Queen of Scots

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal blue lines across its entire width. The lines are thin and consistent in color, set against a plain white background. There are no margins, text, or other markings present on the page.

Exam Q6. Explain why Elizabeth was reluctant to marry when she became queen.
Stimulus: Royal power / Foreign suitors

[illegible]

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Exam Q7. 'The problem of Elizabeth's legitimacy was the main problem she faced when she became queen in 1558.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Royal finances / The French threat

Exam Q8. 'Financial weakness was Elizabeth's main problem when she became queen in 1558.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: The Crown's debt / Elizabeth's legitimacy

General Notes

L2: KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the key features and impact of Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559), including the Act of Supremacy and the Act of Uniformity.
- ☐ Analyse the crucial role of the Church of England in society, specifically its function in enforcing social control, managing Church courts, and conducting visitations.
- ☐ Evaluate the nature and extent of the Puritan and Catholic challenges to the religious settlement, including the role of the nobility, the Papacy, and foreign powers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What vital English territory was lost to France in 1559 under the Treaty of Cateau-Cambr sis?

2. Define: Queen Regnant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Auld Alliance' viewed as a direct geographical threat to Elizabethan England?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the financial weaknesses Elizabeth inherited in 1558.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Puritan Recusant Royal Injunctions Visitations

Your Sentence:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q9. Describe one feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559).

Exam Q10. Describe one feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559).

Exam Q11. Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in society.

Exam Q12. Describe one feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559.

[illegible]

This image shows a single page of white paper with horizontal blue lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, typical of notebook paper or a document template. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

Exam Q14. 'Elizabeth's religious settlement was successful.' How far do you agree?
Stimulus: The 'middle way' / Catholic rebels in England

General Notes

L3: KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the nature and extent of the Puritan challenge, focusing on their theological objections, the Crucifix Controversy, and the Vestment Controversy.
- ☐ Evaluate the Catholic challenge at home, including recusancy and the rising threat of the northern nobility.
- ☐ Analyse the existential threat from abroad, encompassing the Counter-Reformation, the 1570 Papal Bull of excommunication, and the looming shadow of foreign superpowers.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What year was the Religious Settlement passed?

2. Define: Recusant

3. Explain: Why was the 'Act of Supremacy' carefully worded to make Elizabeth the 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about why the Church of England was essential for social control.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Counter-Reformation**

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q15. Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement.

Exam Q16. Describe one feature of the Catholic challenge to the Religious Settlement.

Exam Q17. Describe one feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England.

Exam Q18. Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth’s religious settlement. Stimulus: Vestments / Crucifixes

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 28 horizontal blue lines spaced evenly across the page, typical of standard notebook paper. The lines are thin and light blue, set against a plain white background. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no vertical margin lines or other markings present. The paper appears to be a standard sheet of notebook paper.

Exam Q19. Explain why English Catholics challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement.
Stimulus: Papal authority / Catholic nobility

[illegible]

Blank lined paper for writing.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Exam Q20. 'The most significant challenge to Elizabeth I's religious settlement, in the years 1558–68, came from English Catholics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Recusancy fines / The Puritan campaign against crucifixes

[illegible]

General Notes

L4: KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the strength of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne and why English Catholics viewed her as the legitimate monarch.
- ☐ Explain the dramatic events in Scotland that forced Mary to abdicate and flee across the border into England in 1568.
- ☐ Analyse the profound dilemma Mary's arrival created for Elizabeth, including the investigation into the 'Casket Letters' and the strategic decision to keep her in captivity.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. Recall: What was the main flashpoint of the Vestment Controversy in 1566?

2. Define: The Counter-Reformation

3. Explain: What did the 1570 Papal Bull explicitly instruct English Catholics to do?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Abdicate Casket Letters Divine Right of Kings Conference of York

Following a scandalous marriage to the man suspected of murdering her husband, Scottish nobles rebelled against Mary, forcing her to _____ her throne in favor of her infant son. When Mary fled to England seeking Elizabeth's help, she carried the unshakeable belief that she was chosen by God under the _____. However, Elizabeth refused to restore her to power, instead organizing the _____ to investigate Mary's alleged crimes. The primary evidence presented against Mary were the highly controversial _____, a collection of poems and documents that supposedly proved her involvement in the murder.

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q21. Describe one feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne.

Exam Q22. Describe one feature of the relations between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, in the years 1568–69.

Exam Q23. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in 1568 created problems for Elizabeth. Stimulus: Legitimacy / Catholic alternative

[illegible]

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Exam Q24. 'Mary Queen of Scots was the greatest threat to Elizabeth's rule.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Catholic plots / Foreign intervention

[illegible]

Exam Q25. 'The main cause of tension between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, was Mary's claim to the English throne.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Elizabeth's legitimacy / Plots

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Generated: 2026-08-15 11:53:23 UTC | Unit: eee